

HAONING LI

PhD Candidate in Applied Linguistics, School of the Arts, Queen Mary University of London

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EDUCATION

PhD in Applied Linguistics, Queen Mary University of London expected 2027

Thesis title: *Recontextualising Ergodic Character Gameplay Practice: A Social Semiotic Analysis of Character-Centric Discourse in Gacha Game Interface Interactivity*

Supervisors: Agnieszka Lyons; Nelya Koteyko

Thesis status: final stage of writing-up

Master of Translation and Interpreting, Beijing International Studies University 2021

Areas of focus: Game Localisation; Translation of Multimodal and Multimedia Texts

BA in English, Nanjing University of Finance and Economics 2018

Area of focus: English–Chinese Translation

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Digital Interfaces and Interactivity; Fandom and Popular Culture; Game Studies; Game Translation and Localisation; Media and Communication; Discourse Analysis; Multimodality; Social Semiotics; Applied Linguistics

AWARDS

Research Support Award, School of the Arts Research Committee, Queen Mary University of London 2025–26

Research Support Award, School of the Arts Research Committee, Queen Mary University of London 2024–25

Outstanding Master's Student Award, Beijing International Studies University 2019–21

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles and Book Chapters

Li, H. (in press). Gaming as public communication of humanistic knowledge. In G. Reid, C. Anson, & X. Tan (Eds.), *The Routledge handbook of humanities and social science communication*. Routledge.

Li, H. (in press). Negotiating story and character: A social semiotic analysis of gacha game official video thumbnails. *Languages in Global Contexts*. University of Toronto Press.

Li, H. (2022). An analysis of translation subjectivity and transformation of translator identity in game localisation. *Overseas English*, (13), 13–14, 22. [In Chinese]

Abstracts in Conference Proceedings

- Li, H. (2025). Genre or not: Examining the “-like” suffix as an emergent category expression [Abstract]. In *Abstract proceedings of Chinese DiGRA 2025: Video games in museums*. Digital Games Research Association. <https://doi.org/10.26503/dl.v2025i4.2769>
- Li, H. (2025). Understanding transmedia character-centric discourse in gacha games: A social semiotic analysis of *Genshin Impact* [Abstract]. In *Abstract proceedings of DiGRA 2025: Games at the crossroads*. Digital Games Research Association. <https://doi.org/10.26503/dl.v2025i3.2556>

PRESENTATIONS

Under Review

- Li, H. (2027, June 2–4). *Bringing interactivity onto the canvas: Annotating character-centric interfaces in games* [Paper presentation]. 13th International Conference on Multimodality (13ICOM), Helsinki, Finland.
- Li, H. (2027, February 25–26). *Building with glitches: How players make semiotic resources from malfunction* [Paper presentation]. Pop Cultural Linguistics 2027: Researching and Theorizing Performed Language and Communication, Lecce, Italy.

Presented

- Li, H. (2026, July 1–3). *Recontextualising character progression: A social semiotic analysis of gacha game interface interactivity* [Paper presentation]. 34th European Systemic Functional Linguistics Conference (ESFLC 34), Gothenburg, Sweden.
- Li, H. (2025, November 20–21). *Genre or not: Examining the “-like” suffix as an emergent category expression* [Paper presentation]. Chinese DiGRA 2025: Video Games in Museums, Shanghai, China.
- Li, H. (2025). *Understanding transmedia character-centric discourse in gacha games: A social semiotic analysis of Genshin Impact* [Paper presentation].
- 50th International Systemic Functional Congress and Institute (ISFC 50), Glasgow, United Kingdom, July 7–11, 2025.
 - DiGRA 2025: Games at the Crossroads, Valletta, Malta, June 30–July 4, 2025.
- Li, H. (2024, May 2). *A social semiotic approach to character-driven game design in gacha games* [Paper presentation]. Linguistics Postgraduate Research Afternoon 2024, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Associate, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom

- **EAL4710 Reading and Writing Critically**, Department of International Education Autumn 2026
- Module convenor: Charlotte Assimakopoulos

- **EAL4205 Excellence in Academic Writing 1**, Department of International Education Autumn 2026
Module convenor: Luis Carabantes
- **LIN5206 Applying Linguistics in the Real World**, Department of Linguistics, School of the Arts Spring 2025
Module convenor: Agnieszka Lyons
- Language Tutor (Mandarin Chinese)**, Speaking Practice Team, School of the Arts, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom 2024 – 2026
- Lecturer**, Tangshan Vocational & Technical College, Tangshan, China 2021 – 2023
- **College English**
- **Career Guidance**

TEACHING QUALIFICATIONS

- Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA)**, Advance HE 2026
- Certificate in Learning and Teaching (CILT)**, Queen Mary University of London 2026
- Teacher Qualification Certificate (Higher Education)**, Ministry of Education of the People's Republic of China 2022

RELATED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Translator (part-time)**, Toplingual Service Co., Ltd., Beijing, China 2020 – 2021
- Translator (part-time)**, Eagle Eye Translation Service Co., Ltd., Shanghai, China 2019 – 2020

SERVICE

- Volunteer (host, logistics and event support)**, Guest Speaker Seminar Series, Department of Linguistics, School of the Arts, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom 2026
- Volunteer (logistics and event support)**, Confucius Institute, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom 2024 – 2025
- Volunteer (translation and support)**, First China Public Policy Translation Forum, Beijing, China 2019

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Digital Games Research Association (DiGRA)
- British Association for Applied Linguistics (BAAL)

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

- Languages:** Chinese (native); English (fluent); Japanese (basic)
- Digital skills:** ELAN; LaTeX (basic); Python (basic); R (basic)